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Andrew Green



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by Evan Thomason

The cell block was winding down. It was 3 hours before midnight and the block guard was making his rounds. A voice broke through the clamor.

"Richard, Richie! I got a favor to ask."

Richard made his way over to cell 33. "What do you want Green?"

"I need you to give this to Warden McKenzie. Tell him it's my story, and that I'd like for him to read it. Please Rich, he's got to read it before they pull the lever. Twelve o'clock, can you handle that? I really need you to do this. Call it a last wish if you want."

"I'll see what I can do Green, get some rest."

"Hey Richard, could ya call me Drew."

"No problem Drew, I'll take it to him right now."

"Thanks."

My name is Andrew Green. I'm here in the lock down at the Jersey Pen. I'm here for murder, they say that it was a random murder, a robbery, but that journal Richard just took to McKenzie says otherwise. I knew em, I knew both of em. It was planned, but that doesn't really matter much. I'm gonna fry in three hours. What can I say, I screwed up. It was just one of those crazy moments when you get really friggin hot and you don't know what ya don till ya don it. I recognized them both right away. It would have been alright if they wouldn't have recognized me. But they had to call me Porky. That was their mistake.

Warden McKenzie got the journal just as Richard had promised. He gave it a thought to toss it on his desk and save it for later, but something told him that Drew Green had something important to say. So, he sat down and flipped on his desk light and started at the beginning.

JOURNAL:

I guess ya could say that my troubles started in the third grade. I was your typical fat boy. I had the high pitched giggle wheeze laugh. I loved my Little Debbies and my Twinkies. My favorite super hero was the Pillsbury Dough-Boy. And my whole world revolved around a goddess. Her name was Gretchen Hidlebrook. I would just say that name to give me chills. Gretchen. It made me feel things that a third grader shouldn't feel. Then again, I started school a year late, and was held back in first grade. So, technically I was supposed to be a fifth grader. I was a stupid fat boy.

By the looks of it I was doomed to fail. Porky was my first and worst nickname. Ya don't know how hard it was to have kids two years younger and twice as smart make fun of you. The pain, the anguish, the hunger it caused me. After a while, I gave in. I would have Snickers and Gummy Worms in my desk, Whoppers and Jelly Belly in my pockets, donuts and soda in

my backpack. I was ten and a half years old, in the third grade, and I weighed just over two hundred pounds. Then one day I gave up.

It was never clear to me why God would be so mean to me. I never used his name in vain, or swore. First off he made me dumb, second he made me fat. So, why would he make me the object of ridicule too? All of my childhood was spent crying into my pillow.
No person should have to feel as bad as I did.
No one should be the point of degradation like I was. No one should have to go through the crap that I went through. No one should want to commit suicide at the age of ten and a half. Unfortunately that was me, that was the way that Andrew Porky Green was, for a long time. It takes almost more than I have to write this down, to share my pain. I had it locked up for too long. Now it's your turn to feel what I felt. Your turn to go through the hell that I lived. Your turn to look back on the pricks I had to deal with. Hey, what can I say besides screw them. Screw them for treating me like their little push around fat play toy. Screw them for pushing me down on the playground and shoving rocks in my mouth and forcing me to swallow, telling me that rocks won't make me such a fat ass. Screw them for calling my mom a pig farmer and my dad a dead beat. These words can't even begin to relate what I went through. The only idea you could gather is from the tear stains on the paper. Even then ya probably can't see the pain in each drop. But, like I said earlier, I gave up.

The first time was when the boys had me backed up against the lunchroom wall. Everyone had piled up their mashed potatoes and were ready to make me eat them all. The entire room was one huge roar with the chant 'my taters your taters, they'll make you fat, get them around Porky and they'll be gone like that.' Just as they were going to force feed me, Gretchen called the chant to a stop. She walked up to me, and the room went silent. When she got close to me, she must have smelled the pee that I had running down my leg, and she gagged. I could tell she tried to hold it back, but she gagged again, then one more time. She had stopped the crowd from mauling me, but in return I gave her the smell of a fat kid that pissed himself out of fear. She looked up and gave me a look I could never forget. A look of total disgust. A look that said 'you are a fat piece of crap.' She ran off crying. My one chance of sympathy gone with the smell of my own body. The other kids knew that the look alone was all I needed to be dealt. I would have rather eaten a truck load of potatoes than ever see that look again. I probably would have eaten my own heart. I went home and ate myself to sleep.
I decided after that day that I would only eat if my stomach hurt from hunger. Only when I got weak and had to eat to stand up. I wouldn't eat when I was bored, or tired, or mad, happy, sad, friggin' pissed off. I wasn't going to eat. I would starve until I was normal, until I wasn't picked on. Normal, I've never been normal. Fat ass was dead. No more Andrew Porky Green. I was going to be Drew Green. I was going to get good grades and have friends. Gretchen Hidlebrook was going to notice me again, but this time she would want to be my girlfriend. I would be popular and athletic and have fun.

Ya know what? I actually thought I could do it. Go for a jog instead of plant in front of the tube. It didn't happen. I stayed fat and ridiculed. I was growing into it little by little as I got taller, but I was still called Porky and picked on. It went on for another four years, until I was in middle school. Don't get me wrong, I was still fat, but now I could play football. I used it as my excuse. I told myself that people would be more accepting of a fat kid that was two years older than them. I would be feared and respected. Some of these kids hadn't even started puberty yet, and I had to shave once a week.

It still didn't stop. When I got to high school I pretty much tried to stay away from people in general. The only person I could or would talk to was our counselor. But even she told me to lose weight. I had no friends. The childhood name calling had carried over to my teenage years. The same guys, the same nickname. The only difference was that now I was actually getting beat up. Brent DeOrdio was the main culprit. He had no soul, no compassion. But, he did have Gretchen. It broke my heart to see her wasting her time with him. The guy was a total asshole. Brent DeOrdio actually taught me how to hate.

I remember my freshman year vividly. We were in the same gym class and Brent was the cock jock. First one picked for basketball, kickball, soccer, everything. I, of course, was always picked last. I never minded, I knew I wasn't good at anything. It was when we were in the weight room that things were bad. I was always by myself, no one to help. Brent thought it would be funny one day to drop the bench press bar on my chest with too much weight. No one would help me get it off. I turned colors in the face and still no one would help me, Brent told them not to. I passed out before they took the bar off. I woke up in the shower to Brent relieving himself on me.

He took me to the brink. He could do things to me, but if he ever hurt Gretchen.... I looked for any excuse to graduate early, to get out of my hell. The beatings and torment got so bad I finally dropped out of school. I barely got my G.E.D. and took a job in Jersey in a packing plant. That was six years ago.

A year and a half ago I saw Brent and one of his goons in a Pub over on the east side. I tried to ignore them and drink my beer, but they came over and sat on either side of me. Brent took my glass from me and drank what was left.

"Haven't seen you for a long time Green. I see Richard Simmons didn't do much for ya."

I tried to ignore him but he turned me by my shoulder.

"What do ya want Brent?"

"I want for you to leave my pub, Porky."

If he hadn't have called me Porky, I probably would have left, but I wasn't a teenager anymore. He couldn't kick me out, he had no right. I made like I was heading for the door, and sat down at another booth. He didn't notice. I just sat there and watched him order another beer acting like the almighty. And there she was, just as beautiful as she was all those years ago. I pictured that day when she saved me from the mashed potatoes and almost took pity on me. Brent's yelling broke my daydream. He was yelling at her, and slamming his glass into the bar. Then he hit her and called her a whore. I froze. I didn't know what to do. I've never stood up to anyone before. When she hit him back I flinched and broke from my booth. I ran right up to that prick and grabbed a bottle off the counter and broke it. He yelled at me but I didn't hear him. I sank the broken bottle into his gut. Then I turned and swiped it across his friends throat. I remember the glee I felt and the power that coursed through my body. Gretchen screamed and started sobbing, so I ran.

I knew I was going to do it. I knew I wasn't going to let Brent out of that bar. That's why I didn't leave, that's why I sat at that booth. I was gonna kill the bastard. I DID kill the bastard. That's why I'm here. I killed Brent DeOrdio and Patrick Donavon. I friggin killed them both with a broken beer bottle. McKenzie, you're an honest guy and

I thought ya deserved the truth. Keep this if ya want, or toss it, it really won't matter much. Thanks for your time. Sincerely Andrew Robert Green.

Warden McKenzie shut the journal and picked up his documents. It was time that justice was served. When he was face to face with Green he gave almost an encouraging smile.

"That's my story Warden, that's the true confession and why I killed em. They needed to die. They deserved to die. Now, I deserve to die. I just hope that they don't have nicknames where I'm going."

McKenzie gave Drew a somber smile and a look of sympathy. He knew that there was more good than bad in Drew's heart. Sadly he looked at the switch man and gave him a nod.

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